Yellowstone

Yellowstone National Park
Idaho / Montana / Wyoming

National Park Service
U.S. Department of the Interior

Old Faithful Geyser
© PATRICK LEITZ

The Restless Giant

At the heart of Yellowstone's past, present, and future lies a **SUPERVOLCANO**. Huge volcanic eruptions occurred here, the latest about 631,000 years ago. The center of what is now the park collapsed, forming a 30- by 45-mile caldera, or basin. The heat powering those eruptions still fuels the park's geysers, hot springs, fumaroles, and mudpots.

The park's **ECOSYSTEMS** range from near-desert vegetation at the North Entrance to subalpine meadow and forest on Mount Washburn. They support a variety of habitats that sustain diverse wildlife like bison (buffalo), elk, grizzly and black bears, wolves, trumpeter swans, and Yellowstone cutthroat trout.

PEOPLE also have been part of Yellowstone for more than 13,000 years. Many Native American tribes still have deep connections here. Discover your own connections to the park as you explore its wonders.

Wild iris
NPS

The supervolcano feeds the world's largest group of **HYDROTHERMAL FEATURES.**

Abyss Pool in West Thumb Geyser Basin
© FIONA DONALD

HOT SPRINGS are the most common hydrothermal features in the park. They vary from frothing mocha-like boiling water to clear and calm pools of tremendous depth. Surface water seeps underground, is heated by a deep source of magma, and rises to the surface as superheated water. Hot springs have no constrictions, so water rises, cools, and sinks freely.

Riverside Geyser in Old Faithful Area
NPS / NEAL HERBERT

GEYSERS erupt with steaming hot water. They are hot springs with narrow spaces in their plumbing, usually near the surface. The constrictions prevent water from circulating easily to the surface where heat would escape. The deepest circulating water can exceed the surface boiling point (199°F/93°C). The Old Faithful area has the most famous geysers; some eruptions can be predicted.

Canary Spring at Mammoth Hot Springs
© CRAIG VOTH

TRAVERTINE TERRACES are found at Mammoth Hot Springs, where the interactions of water and limestone create chalk-white travertine. These terraces are among the fastest changing features in the park, emerging quickly and drying up just as fast. Compare Canary Spring in 2012 (*above*) with what it looks like today.

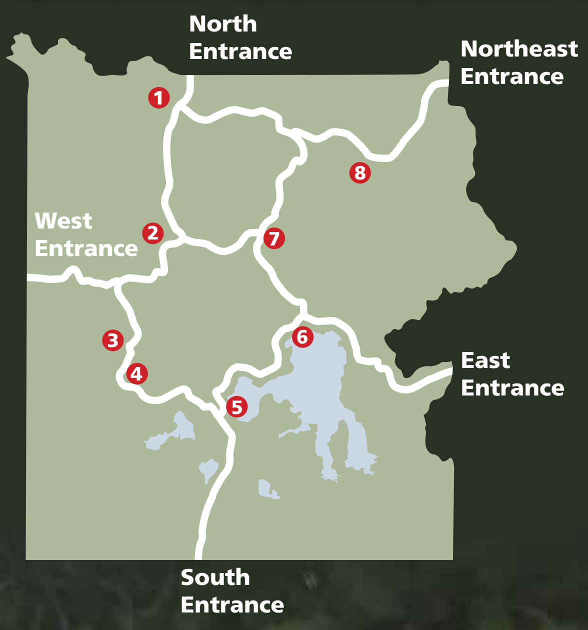
Roaring Mountain, between Mammoth and Norris
© PATTY PICKETT

FUMAROLES (steam vents) are the hottest hydrothermal features in the park. The small amount of water in fumaroles flashes into steam before it reaches the surface. Fumaroles hiss, whistle, or thump if the steam pathway is restricted at the surface. They are easiest to see in cool weather. Look for fumaroles in the major hydrothermal areas.

Mudpots at Artists Paintpots
© MARK WILTRAKIS

MUDPOTS are acidic hot springs with a limited water supply. Acid from volcanic gases and microorganisms decompose the surrounding rock into clay and mud. Mudpot consistency and activity vary with the seasons and precipitation. You can see mudpots at Artists Paintpots, Norris Geyser Basin, Fountain Paint Pots, West Thumb Geyser Basin, and Mud Volcano.

EVERY CORNER of Yellowstone reveals the park's rich array of nature and history.



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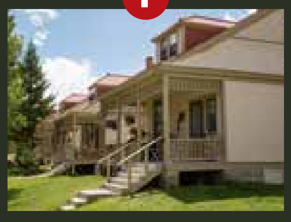
MAMMOTH HOT SPRINGS features ever-changing travertine terraces and historic FORT YELLOWSTONE. A self-guiding tour explores the US Army's role in protecting the park in its first decades.
NPS / NEAL HERBERT

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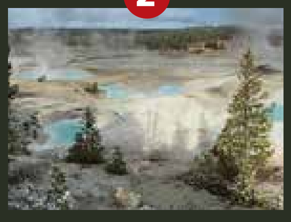
NORRIS GEYSER BASIN is the park's hottest, most dynamic geyser basin. It includes Steamboat, the world's tallest geyser. The nearby Museum of the National Park Ranger showcases the history of these iconic public servants.
NPS / JIM PEACO

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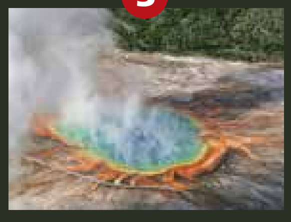
MIDWAY GEYSER BASIN hosts the world's largest geyser, Excelsior, and the world's largest hot spring, Grand Prismatic (*above*). Boardwalks take you past these features, and a nearby trail leads you to an elevated view.
NPS / JIM PEACO

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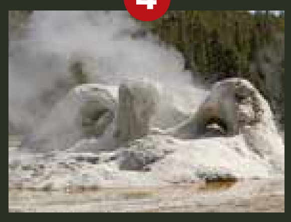
OLD FAITHFUL is more than its namesake world-famous geyser (*top photo*). You can view hundreds of other geysers (Grotto, *above*) and hot springs. Take a self-guiding tour of the historic district, which includes Old Faithful Inn.
NPS / JIM PEACO

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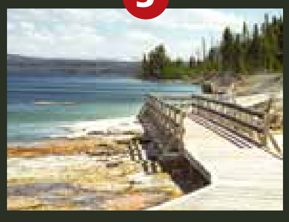
WEST THUMB includes mudpots, boiling springs, and geysers that discharge into the chilly waters of Yellowstone Lake. At the GRANT VILLAGE Visitor Center, enjoy the scenery while you learn about the role of fire in Yellowstone.
© PETER DUTTON

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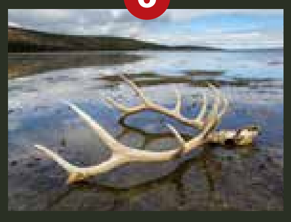
LAKE VILLAGE offers vistas of Yellowstone Lake from the comfort of historic Lake Hotel. The lake is the largest high-elevation lake (above 7,000 feet) in North America. It is more than 400 feet deep with 141 miles of shoreline.
NPS / NEAL HERBERT

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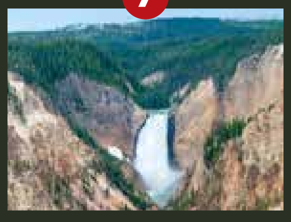
CANYON AREA features the colorful Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone River and the Upper and Lower falls from overlooks and walkways. Away from the rim, trails take you through meadows and grasslands.
© JOHN STROTHER

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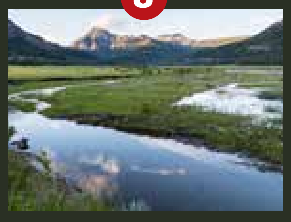

The **LAMAR VALLEY** has been a wolf-watching destination since wolves were reintroduced to Yellowstone in 1995. It is also home to herds of bison and elk, and many black and grizzly bears.
NPS / JACOB W. FRANK

Gray wolf
© EDD MARTINEZ

Bison
NPS / NEAL HERBERT

Yellowstone cutthroat trout
NPS / JAY FLEMING

THE WONDER OF YELLOWSTONE'S WILDLIFE

You have the rare opportunity to view animals who are wild and behave like their ancient ancestors. They eat the same foods, they migrate along the same routes, and they breed on the same cycles. When you watch animals in Yellowstone, you witness the complex interplay of life.

Animals are seldom seen in the dense, dark forest that covers most of the park. They are more easily seen in open areas, like meadows, where vegetation is shorter and more light is available. These areas are shown in beige on the park map (*see the other side of this brochure*).

Other tips
- Look at dawn and dusk when many animals are most active.
- Be quiet and listen for a few minutes; you might hear animals before you see them.
- Use binoculars or spotting scopes to observe animals while staying at a safe distance.

STAY SAFE WHILE WATCHING WILDLIFE

The animals living in Yellowstone are not tame. All of them are wild. Some seem to tolerate humans, but that can change without warning. We jeopardize their survival if we threaten their safety, the safety of their young, or interrupt their ability to get food. Yellowstone has rules to keep both wildlife and humans safe.

Never feed animals, not even small ones like chipmunks.
Store all food properly. Keep food, cooking tools, coolers, and trash in a bear-resistant container unless in immediate use. Animals who find food at picnic areas and campsites will come back, and can be dangerous.

Do not approach wildlife. You must stay at least 100 yards from bears and wolves, and 25 yards from bison, elk, and other animals (*guide below*).
Pay attention. Move away if an animal moves closer to you or changes its behavior due to your presence.
Be respectful. Do not surround, crowd, or disrupt an animal's path of movement.

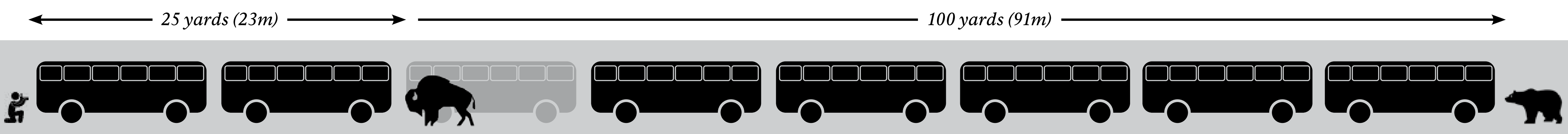
STAY SAFE IN THERMAL AREAS

Yellowstone National Park also has rules to keep you safe as you visit its hydrothermal areas.

- Stay on boardwalks and designated trails.
- Do not push or shove other people.
- Keep your children close to you.
- Keep hands and feet out of the water.

Enjoy watching Yellowstone's animals but **STAY SAFE**. They are **WILD** and **DANGEROUS**.

KNOW YOUR DISTANCE
Use this guide to visualize the safe and legal distance you need to be from Yellowstone's animals.



Exploring Yellowstone

Services and Facilities

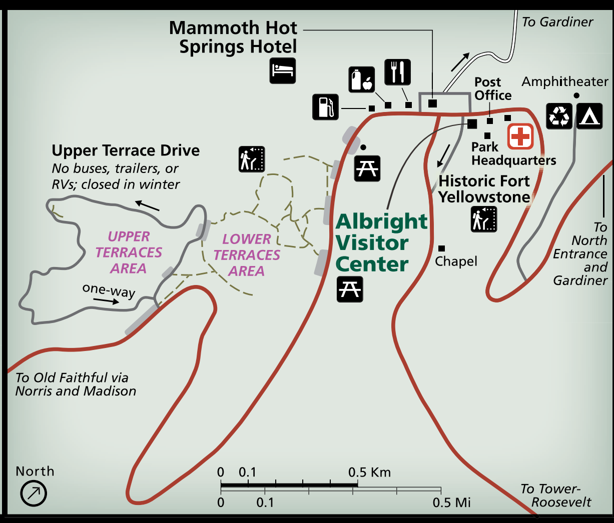
Find dates and hours of operation in the park newspaper and on www.nps.gov/yell.

Accessibility **We strive to make facilities, services, and programs accessible to all. Ask at visitor centers for a free guide to wheelchair-accessible places in the park, or visit the park website.**

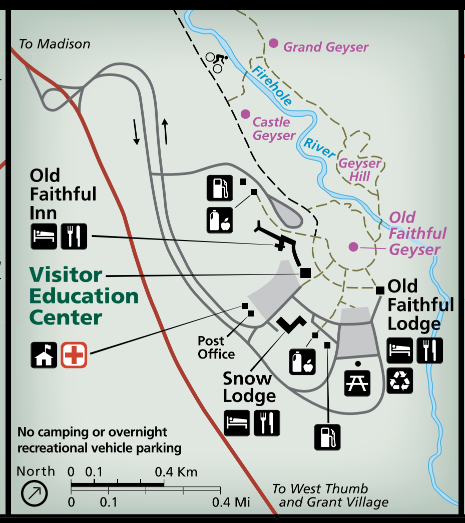
Emergencies Call 911

- Medical clinic
- Parking area (*see detail maps at right*)
- Ranger station
- Campground
- Lodging
- Food service
- Picnic area
- Store
- Gas station (*some have auto repair*)
- Recycling
- Self-guiding trail or boardwalk
- Horseback riding
- Boat launch

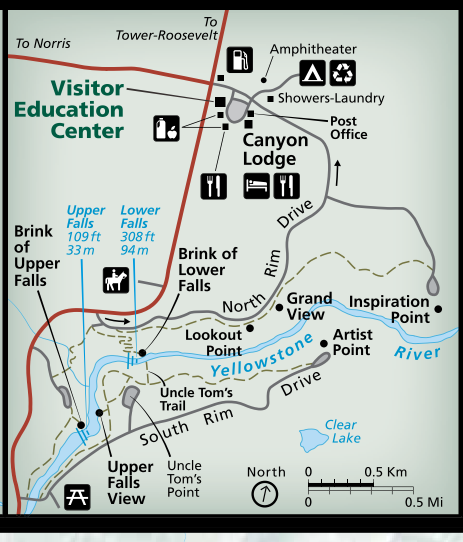
Mammoth Hot Springs
6239ft 1902m



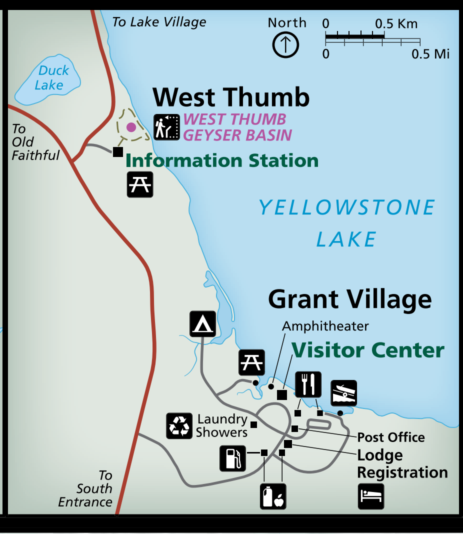
Old Faithful
7365ft 2245m



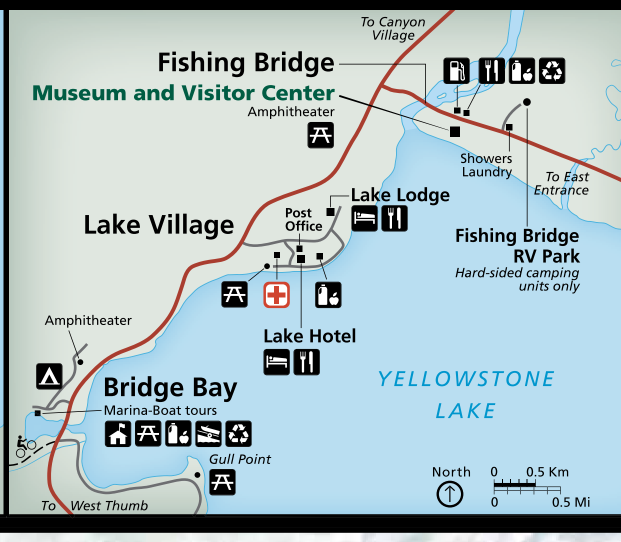
Canyon Village
7918ft 2413m

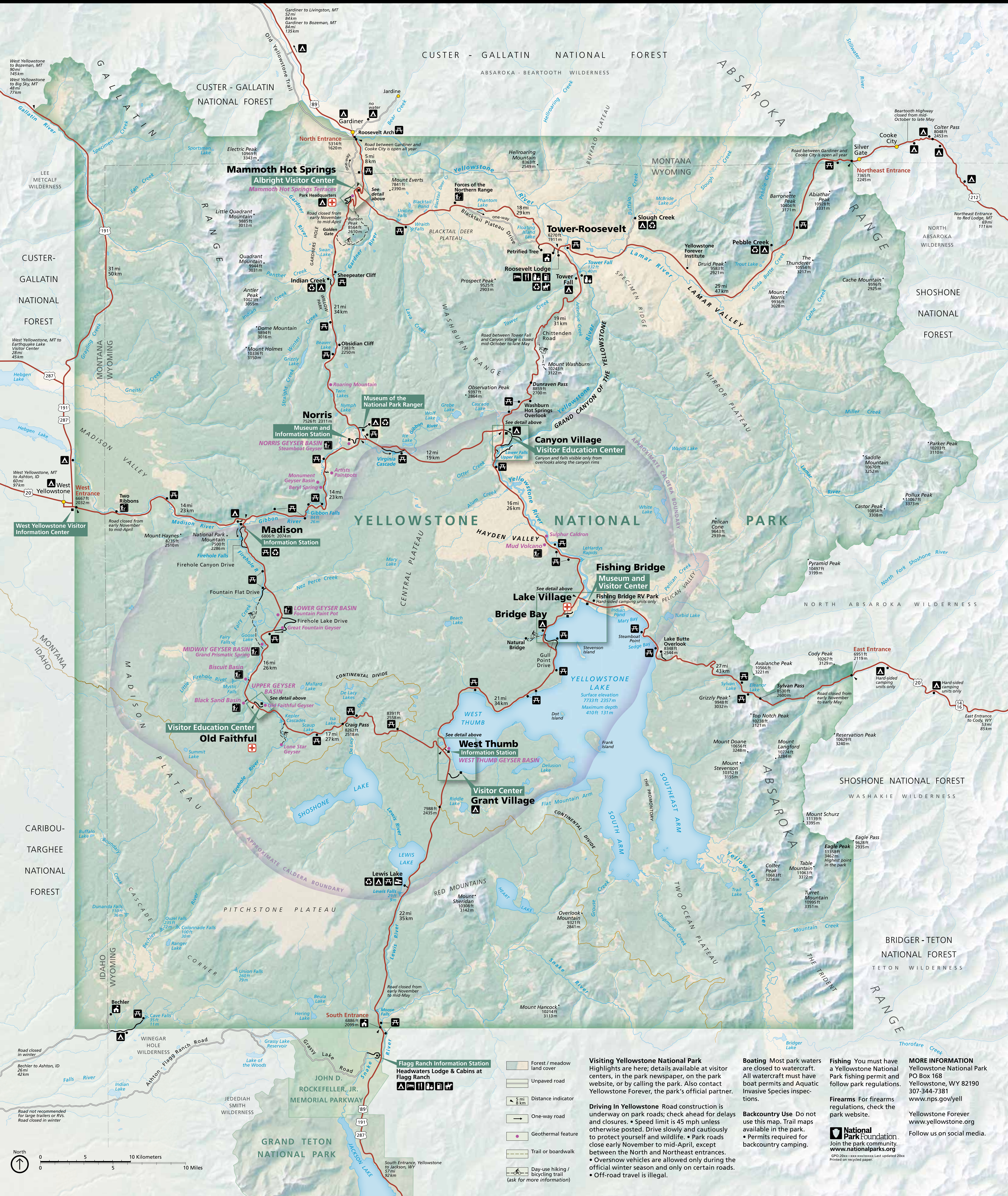


West Thumb • Grant Village
7770ft 2368m



Fishing Bridge • Lake Village • Bridge Bay
7735ft 2358m




Gardiner to Livingston, MT 52mi 84km
Gardiner to Bozeman, MT 84mi 135km
Old Yellowstone Trail
CUSTER - GALLATIN NATIONAL FOREST
ABSAROKA - BEARTOOTH WILDERNESS
ABSAROKA
GALLATIN
Gardiner
Jardine
no water
Roosevelt Arch
North Entrance 5314ft 1620m
Road between Gardiner and Cooke City is open all year
5mi 8km
Mammoth Hot Springs
Albright Visitor Center
Mammoth Hot Springs Terraces
Park Headquarters
See detail above
Electric Peak 10969ft 3343m
Sportsman Lake
Mount Everts 7841ft 2390m
Hellroaring Mountain 8363ft 2549m
BUFFALO PLATEAU
MONTANA WYOMING
Forces of the Northern Range
Blacktail Plateau Drive
one-way
BLACKTAIL DEER PLATEAU
18mi 29km
Tower-Roosevelt 6270ft 1911m
Petrified Tree
Roosevelt Lodge
Tower Fall 132ft 40m
Slough Creek
Lamar River
LAMAR VALLEY
Yellowstone Forever Institute
Pebble Creek
Silver Gate
Cooke City
Northeast Entrance 7365ft 2245m
Beartooth Highway closed from mid-October to late May
Colter Pass 8048ft 2453m
Road between Gardiner and Cooke City is open all year
Barronette Peak 10404ft 3171m
Abiathar Peak 10928ft 3331m
Druid Peak 9583ft 2921m
The Thunderer 10554ft 3217m
29mi 47km
Cache Mountain 9596ft 2925m
Mount Norris 9936ft 3028m
Northeast Entrance to Red Lodge, MT 69mi 111km
NORTH ABSAROKA WILDERNESS
SHOSHONE NATIONAL FOREST
Little Quadrant Mountain 9985ft 3013m
Quadrant Mountain 9944ft 3031m
Bunsen Peak 8564ft 2610m
Golden Gate
Road closed from early November to mid-April
Swan Lake
Sheepeater Cliff
Indian Creek
Antler Peak 10023ft 3055m
21mi 34km
Prospect Peak 9525ft 2903m
SPECIMEN RIDGE
WASHBURN RANGE
Road between Tower Fall and Canyon Village is closed mid-October to late May
Chittenden Road
19mi 31km
Mount Washburn 10243ft 3122m
Dunraven Pass 8859ft 2700m
Washburn Hot Springs Overlook
Observation Peak 9397ft 2864m
GRAND CANYON OF THE YELLOWSTONE
MIRROR PLATEAU
Dome Mountain 9894ft 3016m
Mount Holmes 10336ft 3150m
Obsidian Cliff 7383ft 2250m
Beaver Lake
Grizzly Lake
Roaring Mountain
Twin Lakes
Nymph Lake
Museum of the National Park Ranger
Norris 7526ft 2311m
Museum and Information Station
NORRIS GEYSER BASIN
Steamboat Geyser
Virginia Cascade
12mi 19km
Canyon Village
Visitor Education Center
Canyon and falls visible only from overlooks along the canyon rims
Lower Falls
Upper Falls
See detail above
Cascade Lake
Grebe Lake
Wolfe Lake
Ice Lake
Wapiti Lake
APPROXIMATE CALDERA BOUNDARY
Parker Peak 10203ft 3110m
Saddle Mountain 10670ft 3252m
Pollux Peak 11067ft 3373m
Castor Peak 10854ft 3308m
Pelican Cone 9643ft 2939m
White Lake
Miller Creek
West Yellowstone to Bozeman, MT 90mi 145km
West Yellowstone to Big Sky, MT 48mi 77km
CUSTER-GALLATIN NATIONAL FOREST
LEE METCALF WILDERNESS
31mi 50km
West Yellowstone, MT to Earthquake Lake Visitor Center 28mi 45km
Hebgen Lake
MONTANA WYOMING
MADISON VALLEY
West Yellowstone, MT to Ashton, ID 60mi 97km
West Yellowstone
West Entrance 6667ft 2032m
West Yellowstone Visitor Information Center
Two Ribbons
Road closed from early November to mid-April
14mi 23km
Madison 6806ft 2074m
Information Station
Monument Geyser Basin
Artists Paintpots
Beryl Spring
Gibbon Falls 84ft 26m
14mi 23km
Mount Haynes 8235ft 2510m
National Park Mountain 7500ft 2286m
Firehole Falls
Firehole Canyon Drive
YELLOWSTONE NATIONAL PARK
HAYDEN VALLEY
16mi 26km
Sulphur Caldron
Mud Volcano
LeHardys Rapids
Fishing Bridge
Museum and Visitor Center
Fishing Bridge RV Park
Hard-sided camping units only
Lake Village
See detail above
Bridge Bay
Natural Bridge
Gull Point Drive
Indian Pond
Mary Bay
Steamboat Point
Sedge Bay
Stevenson Island
Lake Butte Overlook 8348ft 2544m
Turbid Lake
PELICAN VALLEY
Pyramid Peak 10497ft 3199m
NORTH ABSAROKA WILDERNESS
East Entrance 6951ft 2119m
27mi 43km
Avalanche Peak 10566ft 3221m
Cody Peak 10267ft 3129m
Sylvan Pass 8530ft 2600m
Sylvan Lake
Eleanor Lake
Hard-sided camping units only
Road closed from early November to early May
Grizzly Peak 9948ft 3032m
Top Notch Peak 10238ft 3121m
East Entrance to Cody, WY 53mi 85km
Reservation Peak 10629ft 3240m
Mount Doane 10656ft 3248m
Mount Langford 10774ft 3284m
Mount Stevenson 10352ft 3155m
SHOSHONE NATIONAL FOREST
WASHAKIE WILDERNESS
Fountain Flat Drive
Nez Perce Creek
LOWER GEYSER BASIN
Fountain Paint Pot
Firehole Lake Drive
Great Fountain Geyser
MIDWAY GEYSER BASIN
Grand Prismatic Spring
Biscuit Basin
16mi 26km
UPPER GEYSER BASIN
See detail above
Old Faithful Geyser
Black Sand Basin
Mystic Falls
Visitor Education Center
Old Faithful
Kepler Cascades
Scaup Lake
Isa Lake
Craig Pass 8262ft 2518m
17mi 27km
8391ft 2558m
Lone Star Geyser
Summit Lake
CENTRAL PLATEAU
Mary Lake
Beach Lake
CONTINENTAL DIVIDE
De Lacy Lakes
21mi 34km
WEST THUMB
YELLOWSTONE LAKE
Surface elevation 7733ft 2357m
Maximum depth 410ft 131m
Dot Island
Frank Island
See detail above
West Thumb
Information Station
WEST THUMB GEYSER BASIN
Delusion Lake
Visitor Center
Grant Village
Riddle Lake
Flat Mountain Arm
THE PROMONTORY
SOUTHEAST ARM
SOUTH ARM
SHOSHONE LAKE
MADISON PLATEAU
7988ft 2435m
Lewis River
LEWIS LAKE
Lewis Lake
Lewis Falls 29ft 9m
RED MOUNTAINS
Mount Sheridan 10308ft 3142m
Heart Lake
Overlook Mountain 9321ft 2841m
TWO OCEAN PLATEAU
Chipmunk Creek
Mount Schurz 11139ft 3395m
Eagle Pass 9628ft 2935m
Eagle Peak 11358ft 3462m Highest point in the park
Colter Peak 10683ft 3256m
Table Mountain 11063ft 3372m
Turret Mountain 10995ft 3351m
Trail Lake
Yellowstone River
Mountain Creek
THE TRIDENT
BRIDGER-TETON NATIONAL FOREST
TETON WILDERNESS
RANGE
CARIBOU-TARGHEE NATIONAL FOREST
Buffalo Lake
Dunanda Falls 110ft 34m
Ouzel Falls 235ft 72m
Colonnade Falls 100ft 30m
Bechler River
Ranger Lake
PITCHSTONE PLATEAU
CASCADE CORNER
Union Falls 260ft 79m
22mi 35km
Road closed from early November to mid-May
Moose Falls
Beula Lake
Hering Lake
South Entrance 6886ft 2099m
Mount Hancock 10214ft 3113m
IDAHO WYOMING
Bechler
Cave Falls 35ft 11m
Road closed in winter
Bechler to Ashton, ID 26mi 42km
WINEGAR HOLE WILDERNESS
Ashton - Flagg Ranch Road
Grassy Lake Reservoir
Grassy Lake Road
Lake of the Woods
Indian Lake
Road not recommended for large trailers or RVs. Road closed in winter
JEDEDIAH SMITH WILDERNESS
JOHN D. ROCKEFELLER, JR. MEMORIAL PARKWAY
Snake River
Flagg Ranch Information Station
Headwaters Lodge & Cabins at Flagg Ranch
GRAND TETON NATIONAL PARK
JACKSON LAKE
South Entrance, Yellowstone to Jackson, WY 57mi 92km
Bridger Lake
Thorofare Creek
North
0 5 10 Kilometers
0 5 10 Miles

- Forest / meadow land cover
- Unpaved road
- 5 mi 8 km Distance indicator
- → One-way road
- ● Geothermal feature
- Trail or boardwalk
- Day-use hiking / bicycling trail (*ask for more information*)

Visiting Yellowstone National Park Highlights are here; details available at visitor centers, in the park newspaper, on the park website, or by calling the park. Also contact Yellowstone Forever, the park's official partner.

Driving In Yellowstone Road construction is underway on park roads; check ahead for delays and closures. • Speed limit is 45 mph unless otherwise posted. Drive slowly and cautiously to protect yourself and wildlife. • Park roads close early November to mid-April, except between the North and Northeast entrances.
- Oversnow vehicles are allowed only during the official winter season and only on certain roads.
- Off-road travel is illegal.

Boating Most park waters are closed to watercraft. All watercraft must have boat permits and Aquatic Invasive Species inspections.

Backcountry Use Do not use this map. Trail maps available in the park.
- Permits required for backcountry camping.

Fishing You must have a Yellowstone National Park fishing permit and follow park regulations.

Firearms For firearms regulations, check the park website.

National Park Foundation
Join the park community.
www.nationalparks.org

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